



Vote on hepatitis B guidance is postponed

CDC panel reconsidering stance that all newborns should get the vaccine

BY LENA H. SUN AND PAIGE WINFIELD CUNNINGHAM

ATLANTA — Federal vaccine advisers selected by Health Secretary Robert F. Kennedy Jr. delayed until Friday a vote to lift a long-standing recommendation for all newborns to get the hepatitis B vaccine in what would be the most sweeping revision to the childhood vaccine schedule under Kennedy.

The advisers heard presentations in the morning — including from two prominent vaccine critics recently hired by the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention — casting doubt on the safety and necessity of a three-dose series of hepatitis B vaccines given to babies, despite widespread agreement by medical and public health experts that the vaccine is safe and effective.

The 11-member panel was scheduled to vote midafternoon on recommending the vaccine at birth only for infants born to mothers with infections. It would recommend other parents delay the first dose for babies for at least two months and consult with their doctors about if or when to administer it. But some members were frustrated at last-minute changes to the language, and the panel agreed 7-3 to delay a vote so they could have more time to review it.

“We really need to know what we’re voting on,” said panel member Joseph Hibbeln, a psychiatrist.

While babies born to uninfected

SEE HEPATITIS B ON A10

Appeals court allows Guard to remain in D.C. for now

Ruling is temporary as judges review arguments over deployment

BY JENNY GATHRIGHT

The Trump administration will be allowed to continue its National Guard deployment in D.C. at least temporarily, pending another appeals court decision, a panel of U.S. Court of Appeals judges said Thursday.

The ruling means the deployment of troops to the nation’s capital could persist beyond Dec. 11, the date a lower-court judge had previously set as a deadline for the administration to halt the mission. Last month, that U.S. District Court judge handed D.C. a preliminary legal win in its lawsuit over the deployment, writing in an opinion that it was illegal and ordering the administration to pause it while litigation proceeds.

The Trump administration then asked the appeals court to intervene and allow the troops to remain longer — and on Thursday, judges with the D.C. Circuit of the U.S. Court of Appeals granted an administrative stay in the case, meaning the drawdown of troops

SEE GUARD ON A2

U.S. officials encouraged cities to adopt the Vision Zero plan to prevent pedestrian deaths. Driver opposition and a lack of money derailed it.



ETHAN SWOPE/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Broken promises on road safety

BY RACHEL WEINER, IAN DUNCAN, EMMANUEL MARTINEZ AND DYLAN MORIARTY

LOS ANGELES — As the sun set over the Pacific Ocean one Sunday this past spring, Cecilia Milbourne returned from a walk on the beach with her dog, Gucci. To reach her parked Tesla, she had to cross a road that city officials have known for years poses a danger to people on foot.

Eight years ago, as part of a national initiative to stem traffic deaths called Vision Zero, the city shrank the number of lanes on the road, Vista Del Mar, and several connecting streets in the shoreside community just south of Venice. But they restored it to four lanes after an uproar by drivers — among them Octavio Girbau, who railed against a city official in a 2017 Facebook post stating he was stuck on one of those intersecting roads “in the traffic hell you created.”

On March 16, Girbau was driving south on



COURTESY OF KIM MILBOURNE

Vista Del Mar as Milbourne was about to cross in a spot with no crosswalk and no sidewalk — just a concrete curb separating her from the moving cars. Girbau bumped another car, lost control and struck Milbourne on the side of the road, sending her flying as his Mercedes flipped onto the beach, according to a police report. Milbourne, 29, a hairdresser and actor who had moved to Los Angeles from Atlanta, was pronounced dead at the scene. Her dog died with her.

Milbourne’s death on the hazardous road encapsulates the widespread failure of Vision Zero, a plan endorsed by the federal government during the Obama administration and adopted by cities across the country. The core concept, which emulates a Swedish model, is that the government — through engineering,

SEE ON A8

Cecilia Milbourne and her dog, Gucci, were killed in March as they were about to cross Vista del Mar in Los Angeles, at a spot without a crosswalk or a sidewalk. Eight people have been killed on the road since 2015.

New trove sheds light on Syria’s killing machine

Photos depict 10,000 people who had died in detention under the last decade of brutal Assad regime

BY KAREEM FAHIM, ZAKARIA ZAKARIA AND AMIR MUSAWY

INKHIL, SYRIA — Mutlaq Mutlaq’s family spent nearly a decade searching for him after his arrest in 2015 but found nothing. Year after year, they pleaded with the gatekeepers at President Bashar al-Assad’s security branches and prisons. When Assad was toppled a year ago, they combed Syria’s mass graves.

Finally, a photograph provided some terrible clarity about his fate. An artifact of a brutal state’s bureaucracy, the photo showed Mutlaq, in high resolution, naked and bearing signs of torture. His name, in green marker, was scrawled on his stomach, above a bright red bloodstain on his hip. His family’s long search had been in vain, the photograph’s metadata indicated. Mutlaq had died just months after his arrest.

The picture is part of a massive trove containing more than 70,000 images taken by Syrian military police photographers

SEE SYRIA ON A12



OMAR HAJ KADOUR/AFP/GETTY IMAGES

A man, back left, is helped as he transports the remains of a relative he identified among bodies found bearing signs of torture in the morgue of a hospital in Damascus, Syria, on Dec. 10, 2024.

Strike footage shocks critics

2 SURVIVORS KILLED TRYING TO FLIP BOAT

Aggressive questioning for admiral in charge

BY NOAH ROBERTSON, ELLEN NAKASHIMA, ALEX HORTON AND MAEGAN VAZQUEZ

Video footage of a U.S. military strike on alleged drug smugglers in the Caribbean Sea shows two people attempting to flip their capsized vessel as they were attacked again, multiple lawmakers said Thursday after speaking with the Navy admiral who oversaw the controversial mission.

The recording was shown during a day of closed-door meetings on Capitol Hill featuring Adm. Frank M. Bradley, the commander who oversaw the Sept. 2 operation, which entailed four strikes in all. The attack killed 11 people, including the two people who survived the first blast that hit their boat.

Democrats emerged from the meetings alarmed and vowed to press ahead with nascent congressional inquiries scrutinizing the attack’s legality. Some Republicans who have been staunchly loyal to the Trump administration defended the operation — in some cases citing the same claims made by the president, who said the lethal campaign was necessary

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Signalgate: Report says Hegseth actions were a security risk. A3

Billionaire’s downballot bid reshapes justice in U.S.

Soros’s push to help local progressives sparks ire on right, unease on left

BY BETH REINHARD

PORTLAND, MAINE — When the ads sullying District Attorney Jonathan Sahrbeck began hitting mailboxes and televisions about three weeks before the 2022 Democratic primary, he and his opponent were equally stunned.

Like many modern-day campaign attacks, the ads came from an independent political committee bankrolled by a billionaire — in this case, the former hedge fund manager and liberal philanthropist George Soros, who set out a decade ago to elect district attorneys who would steer drug offenders and juveniles toward rehabilitation instead of prison, oppose cash bail for minor crimes, and crack down on police misconduct.

As the ads battered Sahrbeck, his challenger, fellow Democrat Jacqueline Sartoris, felt as if her campaign had been hijacked. Her father, a staunch Republican averse to Soros’s left-wing agenda, urged her to left-wingly repudiate him. Supporters asked

SEE SOROS ON A6

IN THE NEWS

Arrest in Virginia Federal officials seized a man accused of planting pipe bombs in D.C. the night before the Jan. 6, 2021, riots. B13

Defense Department is sued The New York Times alleged that the Pentagon’s new rules for the press corps violate the First and Fifth amendments. A2

THE NATION Attacks on DEI could end up hurting White men in college as gender preferences go away. A3

Hearings in Luigi Mangione’s murder case give the most in-depth look at his arrest. A4

THE WORLD China’s control of tungsten has been a key bargaining chip in U.S. trade tensions. A11

The death of an anti-Hamas leader could thwart an Israeli effort to back Gaza clans. A13

THE ECONOMY AI chatbots can change a voter’s mind, and aren’t always fully factual in the process, according to a pair of studies. A15

Find out how to claim a share of an AT&T settlement from its data breaches in 2019 and 2024. A15

STYLE Steve Cropper was little known by the public but was key to the music that defined an era. B1

SPORTS The World Cup draw is today at the Kennedy Center, and while FIFA likes politics left at the door, it has made an exception for Trump. B7

THE REGION House Republicans rejected a bill that would have named a post office in Northeast Washington after go-go legend Chuck Brown. B13

WEEKEND Inside the making of “The Nutcracker,” the Washington Ballet’s biggest show of the year.

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